SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #4 · SCARCITY AND SECURITY

"Asking for help means I've failed."

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Where it often comes from

Families that prized independence, or that were ashamed of needing anything, can teach children that asking is weakness. A person who asked for help and was refused, mocked, or made to feel indebted may stop asking altogether. Pride in self-reliance can also grow from a real history of having to cope alone.

What Scripture teaches

God made us to need one another. Scripture tells us to carry each other's burdens, and it shows even Moses, a great leader, being told that the task was too heavy for him to handle alone. We are invited to come to God's throne of grace for help in our time of need, and Paul learned that God's power is shown in weakness. Asking for help is not failure; it is how God's design for community works.

> *"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ"* (Galatians 6:2).

Also see

> "But Moses' father-in-law said to him, 'What you are doing is not good. Surely you and these people with you will wear yourselves out, because the task is too heavy for you. You cannot handle it alone.'" (Exodus 18:17–18).

> "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need" (Hebrews 4:16).

> "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me" (2 Corinthians 12:9).

> "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!" (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

Common self-statements

- A capable person handles it alone.
- If I ask, people will think less of me.
- I should not need anyone.
- Needing help proves I could not cope.
- I do not want to owe anyone.
- Other people never struggle like this.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either fully independent or a failure.
- Mind reading: Assuming others will judge me for asking.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should never need help.
- Mislabeling: Calling a normal need a personal failure.

Challenging questions

- When someone asks me for help, do I think less of them?

- What happened in the past when I asked for help?
- What has handling everything alone cost me?
- Who has helped me before, and how did it feel to be helped?
- What does Scripture say about carrying one another's burdens?
- What is one small request I could make this week?
- What would I want a friend to do if they were in my shoes?

Truth summary

> Asking for help is not failure. God designed us to help one another, and even strong leaders in Scripture needed help. Needing help does not make me less. I can ask wisely and kindly, receive with thanks, and offer help in return.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Help
- Friendship
- Church
- Humility
- Strength

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Communication

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Asking for help means I've failed"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Asking for help means I've failed." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ When others ask me for help, do I think less of them?
- ☐ What happened when I asked before?
- ☐ What has handling everything alone cost me?
- ☐ Who could I ask this week?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?
- ☐ What small request can I make?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Needing help does not mean I have failed.
- ☐ God made us to carry burdens together.
- ☐ Asking for help is a sign of wisdom.
- ☐ I can receive help and still be capable.
- ☐ Most people are glad to help when they can.
- ☐ I can ask and let the other person decide.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Galatians 6:2**
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ **Hebrews 4:16**
  "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need."
- ☐ **Ecclesiastes 4:9–10**
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I asked and what happened: Write down one request, your fear beforehand from 0 to 10, how the person responded, and how you felt afterward.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Galatians 6:2 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God made us to carry burdens together, so I can ask for help.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Help" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Make one small request. Ask a safe person for a ride, a bit of advice, or help with a task. Record what happened.
- [ ] Name your support team. List three people or groups you could turn to, such as family, friends, church, or a counselor.
- [ ] Seek one practical resource. If money is tight, look up a local assistance service, food program, or church benevolence fund, and note what is available.
- [ ] Thank someone who helped you. Tell them what the help meant, and notice that receiving can be a gift to the giver too.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie “Asking for help means I’ve failed”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A request I made
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Asking for help means I’ve failed.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD’S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You know how hard it is for me to ask. Heal the places where asking brought shame. Show me safe people, help me ask with humility, and teach me that needing others is part of Your design. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.